Discover: The Moon's Journey

Today I can… □ State that the Moon orbits Earth in roughly a month. □ Explain that moonlight is reflected sunlight. □ Explain phases using our changing view of the lit half.

Feedback: □ VF □ WS □ I □ NS □ E □ R □ [//] □ [?] _____

TA brief

Access and independence

No cold calling; nobody is asked to read difficult text aloud.

Beside the You do, mark I (independent), S (supported) or C (choice): the level of independence, not the effort.

Tell the teacher the barrier: reading, vocabulary, processing, regulation, writing or a science misconception. Avoid prompting through every question or dictating the final answer.

A pupil who missed last lesson: give the Arrival reminders and today's must-know words, not the missed lesson's work.

E Evidence on the school's evidence app

Lean capture on the school's evidence app (E): 30-second clip, photo, or one-line context note.

Point, sign, repeat after the adult, demonstrate, a clip on the school's evidence app, choice board.

Only the apparatus for the current stage is on the table. Demonstrate the method first.

If a pupil cannot safely take part, use a teacher demonstration and the same observation-and-conclusion task in the book.

Photograph the practical at the planned point, upload it to the school's evidence app with this code, and stick a copy in the book.

Lesson code: GROW-SCI-A1-W08-P1. Planned photograph: after the observation record and before the conclusion.

Prompt ladder

Prompt ladder for adults

1. Point to the relevant place / instruction.
2. Ask one short question: "What is it asking you to find?"
3. Rephrase the instruction in simpler language.
4. Provide a scaffold or limited choice.
5. Model the first step only, then return the task to the pupil.

00–04 · Arrival task

Read four short retrieval questions, allow independent thinking, then offer a small prompt or two choices. Keep answers in the book. No public test.

04–08 · Starter · choose a first idea

Ask the one opening question. Give thinking time and take a voluntary response. Keep one short answer in the book.

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TA brief · continued

08–12 · I do · make the science visible

Keep the visible model and language linked. Pause at one observation; distinguish what the model shows from its limit.

12–16 · We do · everyone answers

Everyone commits. Secure: transfer. Mixed: compare two choices. Misconception: re-model, then use a fresh example. Access: change response mode.

16–19 · I do · connect the evidence

Model the evidence-to-reason connection; keep the stated limitation visible.

19–24 · We do · Phase or eclipse?

Pupil operates or directs. Name back the clue before any correction. Use the lightest prompt and fade it.

24–33 · You do

One adult supports the pupils needing access; the other holds the group, then swap roles across the week. Keep the first answer; give VF and one NS+; pupil edits // in the same colour on the same page.

33–36 · Review and improve

Use three minutes: hear one precise VF/NS+ (one minute), make a pupil-owned edit (one minute), then receive the explanation of the change (one minute). Keep the original meaning, use // and add R only after genuine adult audience.

36–40 · Exit ticket

Read the response privately. Pupil voice plus adult audience closes R only when both happen. Use the response to choose the next teaching route.

Evidence location

Book work beneath the strip, retained first answer and pupil-owned edit. Keep spoken, practical or photographic evidence under the same code.

Planned adaptation — Cognition and learning

Arrival and independent: one decision at a time; show a worked example, provide the topic word bank and fade the scaffold when the reason is secure.

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TA brief · continued

Planned adaptation — Communication and interaction

We do: private thinking and partner rehearsal; accept pointing, signing, drawing, speaking or exact scribing. The pupil directs the decision.

Planned adaptation — SEMH

Predictable route choice, quiet pause and small re-entry step. Receive uncertainty calmly and keep correction private.

Planned adaptation — Sensory and physical

Model and practical: large diagrams, stable equipment, seated or no-touch director route; follow the topic safety note.

Planned adaptation — EAL

Pre-teach the named science words with the model; permit first-language planning and rehearsal. EAL is not SEN and does not reduce the science goal.

If behind — Must teach core

I can explain why the Moon appears to change shape as it orbits Earth.

If behind — Shorten or merge

Shorten repeated rehearsal after a secure hinge; retain the individual explanation, safety and exit.

If behind — Next lesson

Use this evidence to choose the next topic route.

If behind — Dependency

Pass on the checked explanation and unresolved misconception; a group product cannot replace individual evidence.

Preparation and safety

Cool LED torch, large foam ball, observer marker and four phase cards.

Adult uses a low-power cool light; no lasers or looking at the Sun. No blackout: normal-light diagrams are equal routes. Keep the ball above the observer’s head shadow so a false eclipse is not created. Agree before any light change; adult handles equipment and cutting. Keep movement clear.

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TA brief · continued

First lesson back

Before the lesson, scan the books for five minutes. Look for genuine coverage and unfinished explanations; do not assume a missing page means the pupil was absent.

Ask the cover teacher and TAs what was taught, what was practised and what still needs teaching.

Check the roll against the books so that absence and missing evidence are kept separate.

Existing NS+ is history. Begin fresh feedback from what the pupil shows now; do not retrospectively close an old loop.

After the check, use one read, once, to shape Autumn 2. Choose the next teaching route from the pupil’s evidence; do not add another record.